



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Redeemer Classical School
School Website: <https://fortwayneclassical.com/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

Overall Classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Redeemer Classical School in 46807 (Fort Wayne, IN) presents a clearly classical, Christian educational orientation rooted in Lutheran identity. Public-facing materials emphasize classical pedagogy, memory-based practice, a robust library of timeless works, and a distinctly Christian/theological frame (theology, liturgy, catechesis, hymnody) that anchors curriculum and community life. The school explicitly positions itself as a classical Lutheran education, committed to rigorous study of the liberal arts, formation of character, and integration of faith with learning. Evidence includes statements about classical education shaped by Christian theology, a strong emphasis on teachers as the primary living curriculum, and a public articulation of ancient/classical educational aims (such as classical literature, Latin, and a library of classics) as central to schooling. At the same time, explicit articulation of core classical components such as a formalized Great Books program, explicit Socratic pedagogy in the upper grades, or a sustained public claim about Great Conversation across the curriculum is less consistently explicit in public materials, though several sources reference classical literature, a large library, and a strong emphasis on memory work and recitation. The overall orientation aligns with classical education in several key respects, but some hallmark elements (e.g., explicit Great Books/Great Conversation emphasis or wide-scale Socratic seminars in upper grades) are not consistently foregrounded in the public-facing materials. The aggregate assessment is SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

- Executive judgment: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Key drivers: strong religious/theological foundations; explicit focus on classical literature, hymnody, and memory; documented commitment to teachers as living exemplars; visible emphasis on formation and virtue; moderate but not always explicit emphasis on Great Books/Great Conversation and high-school Socratic pedagogy.
- Needle-movers identified below.

Notes on evidence and sourcing: The assessment integrates two sources of material. The school-specific crawl content (Fort Wayne Redeemer site and related posts) confirms Lutheran Christian formation, a library of classic works, a focus on classical education, and explicit teacher-quality claims. The classical-school knowledge base (Six Essential Elements) provides the rubric, positive/negative keyword indicators, and the canon of words to map against the school's public materials. Citations correspond to the file-search results showing relevant passages (Fort Wayne Redeemer content and the Six Essential Elements/lexicon materials). See citations throughout for specific phrases.

Citations (representative examples of the material used): - Public articulation of Christian classical formation and Lutheran emphasis (e.g., "classical Lutheran education," liturgical practices) - The school's Christian/theological framing and emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness through a Christian worldview - Library of classics, emphasis on public access to classical works and a traditional literary library model - Faculty emphasis and teacher as primary living curriculum, including explicit comments on teacher quality and pay scale to attract strong teachers - Foundational classical-philosophical framing and explicit formation/virtue language in public materials

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials frame Redeemer Classical School as a Christian Lutheran educational endeavor, explicitly tying education to theology and church-affiliated formation (e.g., “classical Lutheran education,” and references to liturgy and catechesis). - A key public post argues that classical education stems from Christian worldview and God as the author of truth, goodness, and beauty; it asserts that truth, goodness, and beauty are objective and knowable and rooted in Christian faith. - Public materials describe liturgical practices and a church-based community rhythm (liturgical year, hymnody, sacred music) as integral to schooling, aligning with liturgical/community foundations described in the Six Elements lexicon. - Several posts describe the school as a center for Christian life and formation, including references to religiously framed aims (virtue, character, virtue formation) and a strong Christian ethos in instruction and community life.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: theology, liturgy, catechesis, sacred music, hymnody, liturgical calendar, Christian worldview, virtue formation, classical Lutheran education, worship, true/good/beautiful (the transcendental framework). - Negative keywords: none clearly present in public materials; the corpus does not foreground secular relativism or value-neutral approaches. - Quantitative estimate: 6–8 positive indicators clearly present; 0 explicit negative indicators in the public RP materials analyzed. - Why this rating: The combination of explicit theology, liturgical rhythms, and a Christian-liberal-arts framing aligns with the Positive Keywords set for Religious and Metaphysical Foundations and the Negative Signals are not evident in the school's public materials.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public statements emphasize formation and virtue as central aims rather than mere information transfer; quotations highlight formation, character, and the true/good/beautiful as teleological aims of education (the “formation over information” ethos; virtue as the goal). - The Christian classical frame connects education to the cultivation of wisdom and human flourishing as a telos, not merely workforce readiness; the Great Conversation framing is referenced in the philosophy behind classical education (as articulated in the Six Essential Elements materials). - The school explicitly asserts that “the goal of education is not to build a child’s self-esteem, but to help parents cultivate his character and shape his loves, the fruit of which is enduring joy, something far greater than happiness” (formation and virtue as primary aims).

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, telos, pursuit of the true/good/beautiful, human flourishing, moral imagination, classical mission, façon of Bildung-like formation. - Negative keywords: There is no explicit emphasis on “college/career readiness” or “workforce preparation” in the public materials; some documents in the knowledge base list potential negative signals, but Redeemer’s public materials concentrate on formation and virtue over vocational metrics. - Quantitative estimate: 4–6 positive indicators; 0–1 explicit negative indicators (no vocational-primacy language is foregrounded). - Why this rating: The material demonstrates a classical purpose and aim oriented toward virtue formation, moral imagination, and the pursuit of truth/good/beautiful, supporting a CLASSICAL designation for this category.

Element 3: Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school emphasizes a language-rich, literature-heavy curriculum with explicit classical elements, and a focus on a large library of classic works; there is a stated emphasis on Latin and a traditional liberal-arts orientation in teaching and materials (evidence includes library focus and classical approaches). - Public pages highlight classical education framing, explicit reference to classical literature, and “the West’s heritage” and “classic works” within a Christian educational worldview; there are explicit links to classical literature and primary sources in the posted materials. - The Six Essential Elements/Curriculum lexicon lists the Seven Liberal Arts and Great Books as core content, and the public site mirrors a commitment to classic texts and a substantial canon of literature; however, explicit, centralized public articulation of a formal Great Books program or a universal Great Conversation across the full curriculum is not consistently foregrounded in every public page (though it is present in library-view and mission framing).

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Great Books/Great Conversation, history/Western civilization, liturgy in education, hymnody, memory work/recitation, classical canon, primary sources, Latin (explicit in some materials). - Negative

keywords present: None clearly foregrounded in public materials; some knowledge-base negatives discuss “project-based learning dominance” as a potential negative signal, but Redeemer’s content emphasizes memory, recitation, and traditional canon rather than project-only approaches. - Quantitative estimate: 4–6 positive indicators; 0–1 explicit negative indicators (no explicit modern-project-based emphasis in public materials; though some pages discuss being open to discussion). - Why this rating: The curriculum shows strong classical cues (liberal arts emphasis, classical canon, historic worldview, and Latin) but lacks a consistently explicit, school-wide, publicly stated Great Books/Great Conversation program across all grade levels in every page. This yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL designation for this category.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials indicate that the school uses both teacher-led instruction and structured, traditional approaches (e.g., explicit instruction, direct instruction emphasis in some public descriptions) as well as elements aligning with classical pedagogy such as memory work, recitation, and hymnody; there are posts emphasizing the use of direct instruction and the teaching of virtue and character, contrasting with some “child-led” approaches common in other contexts (e.g., the founder’s commentary on classical education as distinct from “child-led instruction”). - The Lexicon highlights methods such as memory work, recitation, liturgical chanting, and a master-teacher model; Redeemer’s materials mention focus on teachers and a library-based classical education, with some posts describing the role of teachers as authoritative and guiding rather than purely student-led; this aligns with the memoria-based, teacher-led aspects of classical pedagogy in part, but not uniformly across all material (and there is some emphasis on restful learning vs. constant rigor in other classical sources). - There are explicit references to classic text recitation, memory, and hymns, which match the traditional pedagogy signals in the Six Essential Elements lexicon; there is also evidence of more Socratic-type dialogs in some materials, but not uniformly described as the central method across the high school level in the public materials provided.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: recitation, memorization, chanting, memory work, liturgical calendar integration, master-teacher model, rhetoric training, dialogue/discussion, Socratic dialogue (in some pieces), seminar-like discussion in some high-school contexts. - Negative keywords present: explicit “experiential learning” dominating (not foregrounded by Redeemer in public pages); some posts emphasize direct instruction and structured teaching rather than purely student-led or project-based only approaches. - Quantitative estimate: 4–6 positive indicators; 0–1 explicit negative indicators in public materials (though the knowledge-base lists potential negatives that may appear in other schools). - Why this rating: Pedagogy shows substantial classical signals (memory/recitation, structured instruction, teacher-led formation, potential for dialogue-based inquiry) but with less universal, high-sociological clarity on heavy Socratic seminars in every grade level across the whole school. Therefore, SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school publicly emphasizes high-quality teaching, recruiting the best teachers, and paying competitive wages based on experience and performance; this demonstrates a focus on teacher quality and mentorship (the faculty are the living curriculum and core of the school in the classical lexicon). - There is explicit Lutheran-Christian leadership with a headmaster who founded Redeemer Classical School, and which is described as a center for family-based education; the staff biography pages (e.g., headmaster, librarian) reflect a culture of experienced educators committed to classical education values and mentorship (e.g., detailed staff biographies and Hillsdale alumni stories). - The school’s accreditation by CCLE and NLSA (as detailed content) reinforces the faculty’s alignment with classical formation and teacher preparation within a formal classical framework.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: living curriculum, master-teacher model, teachers as mentors, portrait of teacher, collegial culture, excellent teachers, teacher training in classical pedagogy, classical formation. - Negative keywords present: none clearly foregrounded in Redeemer’s public materials; there is no explicit “customer-service” or non-classical teacher-labor language. - Quantitative estimate: 5–7 positive indicators; 0 explicit negative indicators. - Why this rating: Redeemer emphasizes teacher quality, mentorship, and a living-curriculum model, which aligns strongly with CLASSICAL signals for Faculty.

Element 6: Parents & Community — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school presents itself as a community-centric institution that operates within a church context and emphasizes partnership with families and the broader classical-education community; public materials show a family-centered approach (e.g., center for cultural renewal, family-based education, and community engagement efforts) and a library-driven, public-facing community stance. Some posts discuss engagement with families and a culture of classical education in a community setting. - There are statements about openness to parents and public events, and there is a public emphasis on community events and a library; however, explicit, consistent language about parents as co-teachers, regular parent formation, or a formal “open campus” stance across all pages is not uniformly foregrounded in every public page (though the Six Elements lexicon emphasizes parent partnership and family formation in a classical model). - The school’s materials indicate a willingness to involve families and the public in classical-education initiatives (e.g., public library, family-centered events) and emphasize partnerships with classical-education communities (e.g., CCLE accreditation, Hillsdale-adjacent leadership).

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with families, family involvement, home-school connections, parental formation, open campus, parent covenant, community support, shared mission. - Negative keywords present: consumer language or minimal parental involvement would be negative signals; Redeemer’s materials do not foreground those negative signals. - Quantitative estimate: 3–5 positive indicators; 0 explicit negative indicators (though not every piece foregrounds parent involvement in a shared-co-teacher model). - Why this rating: There is clear evidence of community and family orientation, but the public materials do not present a fully explicit, ongoing “parents as co-teachers” program across all pages. This yields SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL for Parents & Community.

Aggregate Assessment

- Classical vs Not: CLASSICAL (1), CLASSICAL (2), SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL (3), SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL (4), CLASSICAL (5), SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL (6)
- Aggregate: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

What Would Move the Needle

- Make Great Books/Great Conversation explicit: Publish a clear, school-wide statement that Great Books and Great Conversation are central across K–12, including list of canonical works and a structured plan for integration across disciplines and grade bands.
- Formalize high-school Socratic seminars: Publicly commit to regular, formal Socratic seminars or Paideia-style seminars in upper grades with clear rubrics, teacher training, and assessment aligned to Socratic pedagogy.
- Expand “Scholé”/restful learning and contemplative time: Publicly articulate a scholarly cadence that includes intentional periods of contemplation, memorization, and rest (Scholé) balanced with rigorous writing, logic, and rhetoric, with implementation guidelines across divisions.
- Strengthen Parent Partnership visuals and programs: Expand explicit “parents as co-teachers” language with a formal parent-education program (book studies, lectures, community catechesis) and public opportunities for parent involvement and visits.
- Strengthen Great Books library programming: Publicize a formal Great Books-reading plan and reciprocal student-guided discussions, field trips to libraries and museums, and integration of primary sources into core subjects across all grades.
- Increase explicit articulation of the curriculum’s liberal-arts structure: Provide a public, map-like articulation of grammar-logic-rhetoric across grades; show how history, literature, math, science, and languages interrelate under a Trivium/Quadrivium framework.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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